04-23 第2篇

阅读理解（记叙文）

① The town of Oakville had a strange tradition. Every summer, they held the "Great Tomato Race". People didn't run with tomatoes; instead, they built small wooden boats, put a giant tomato inside, and raced them down the river. No one knew exactly why this started, but it was the most exciting event of the year.

② Twelve-year-old Leo loved building things. This year, he was determined to win. While other kids spent their money on expensive paints and decorations (装饰) for their boats, Leo focused on the design. He spent weeks in his garage, carefully cutting wood and testing out different shapes in his bathtub (浴缸). He wanted a boat that could move swiftly (迅速地) and balance the heavy tomato perfectly.

③ Finally, the race day arrived. The riverbank was crowded with cheering people. Leo's boat looked very simple. It had no bright colors or cool flags like the others. Some kids even laughed at it. "Is that a piece of firewood?" mocked (嘲笑) a boy named Sam, whose boat was shaped like a golden dragon. Leo just smiled politely and gently placed his giant red tomato into his boat.

④ The mayor blew the whistle (口哨). *Splash!* Dozens of boats were dropped into the fast-flowing river. Sam's dragon boat looked wonderful, but it was too heavy. It spun (打转) around and soon got stuck near the riverbank. Other boats tipped over because the tomatoes were too big for them.

⑤ But Leo's simple boat glided (滑行) smoothly on the water. Its special shape cut through the waves easily, and the tomato sat safely in the middle. The crowd cheered as Leo's boat crossed the finish line first. Leo jumped up in joy. He proved that sometimes, how something works is much more important than how it looks.

注释： tradition 传统；decoration 装饰；swiftly 迅速地；mock 嘲笑；whistle 口哨

选择题

1. What was the "Great Tomato Race" in Oakville? A. A race where people ate giant tomatoes as fast as they could. B. A race where people ran carrying heavy tomatoes on their backs. C. A race where small wooden boats carrying a tomato raced down the river. D. A race where people grew the biggest tomato in their gardens.

2. What did Leo focus on when preparing for the race? A. The expensive paints for his boat. B. The bright colors and cool flags. C. The design and shape of his boat. D.

The size of the tomato.

3. Why did Sam mock (嘲笑) Leo's boat? A. Because Leo's boat was too small to hold a tomato. B. Because Leo's boat looked very simple like a piece of firewood. C. Because Leo's boat was painted in an ugly color. D. Because Leo didn't know how to drop the boat into the river.

4. What happened to Sam's dragon boat during the race? A. It crossed the finish line first. B. It glided smoothly on the water. C. It was too fast for anyone to catch. D. It was too heavy, spun around, and got stuck.

5. What can we learn from Leo's success? A. We should always spend a lot of money on decorations. B. A golden dragon is always the best shape for a boat. C. Running fast is the only way to win a race. D. How something works is more important than how it looks.

详细解析

1. 【答案】C

【题型】 细节理解

【定位】 第①段第3句 "...they built small wooden boats, put a giant tomato inside, and raced them down the river."

【解析】 原文中明言所谓“西红柿大赛”是指：大家并不是拿着西红柿跑步，而是造木头小船里面装一个巨型西红柿，让它们顺河竞速。这与C选项完全对应。A（吃西红柿）、B（背着跑步）、D（种西红柿）均非比赛内容。故选C。

2. 【答案】C

【题型】 细节理解

【定位】 第②段 "...Leo focused on the design. He spent weeks in his garage, carefully cutting wood and testing out different shapes..."

【解析】 当别的孩子把钱花在昂贵的油漆和装饰上时，Leo专注于设计（design），并在浴缸里测试不同的形状（shapes）以追求速度和平衡。A项（昂贵油漆）、B项（明亮色彩及旗帜）都是其他孩子关注的，D选项（西红柿的尺寸）文中未提他去特别关注。故选C。

3. 【答案】B

【题型】 细节理解判断

【定位】 第③段第3–5句 "Leo's boat looked very simple. It had no bright colors or cool flags... 'Is that a piece of firewood?' mocked a boy named Sam..."

【解析】 Sam嘲笑Leo的船，是因为Leo的船看起来太简单了，没有鲜艳的色彩和旗帜，以至于Sam讽刺它“那是一块柴火吗（a piece of firewood）”。A、C、D项皆不是Sam嘲笑的出发点。故选B。

4. 【答案】D

【题型】 细节理解

【定位】 第④段第3-4句 "Sam's dragon boat looked wonderful, but it was too heavy. It spun (打转) around and soon got stuck near the riverbank."

【解析】 比赛开始后，Sam的金龙船虽然漂亮但太重了（too heavy），它在水里打转并很快就卡在岸边了（got stuck）。A、B、C项都是正面顺利的情形，不符合Sam失败的结果。故选D。

5. 【答案】D

【题型】 主旨大意

【定位】 第⑤段最后一句 "He proved that sometimes, how something works is much more important than how it looks."

【解析】 Leo的成功靠的是精密的造型设计和平衡性，而非外表花哨。文章最后一句结语点明主旨：有时，事物如何运作（实用性/内在）比它看起来怎样（外表）重要得多。D项正是此主旨的直接复述。A、B、C项违背了这一核心价值观。故选D。